

Weekly Writing - Week 1

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28 August, 2025

1. What should the role of AI be in this course? Should we still be learning R or should the AI be used to do most of the work and we understand the concepts?

I think that AI should not be used as the primary method for writing code in this class and at the moment in general. AI has a very limited capacity to answer real coding questions when trying to do statistical analysis or answer highly specific questions. I have used it to help me write pieces of code but oftentimes to get the code to work for your specific application a fair amount of troubleshooting is necessary. In order to effectively troubleshoot you still need to know a fair amount of R syntax and thus it is still useful to have a class where you are doing most of the programming. Overall AI is a helpful tool but it still requires knowledge about the underlying syntax of the programming language in order to be used effectively. I think the way the course currently approaches AI is reasonable requiring students to cite when it is being used and roughly what each line of the code the AI generated in doing. This helps students build troubleshooting skills and learn R syntax.